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Holtmaat

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(54) **MONARDA PLANT NAMED ‘MONARD0044’**

(50) Latin Name: *Monarda didyma*
Varietal Denomination: **MONARD0044**

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(51) **Int. Cl.**
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(52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./455**
CPC *A01H 5/02* (2013.01)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
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See application file for complete search history.

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct cultivar of *Monarda* plant named
‘MONARD0044’, characterized by its broadly upright plant
habit; dark green-colored leaves; freely flowering habit;
large inflorescences with purple violet-colored flowers; long
flowering period; and tolerance to Powdery Mildew.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Botanical designation: *Monarda didyma*.
Cultivar denomination: ‘MONARD0044’.

**CROSS-REFERENCED TO CLOSELY-RELATED
APPLICATIONS**

Title: *Monarda* Plant Named ‘MONARD0039’
Applicant: Henricus Maria Joseph Holtmaat
Filed: Concurrently with this application Ser. No. 15/732,
923

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar
of *Monarda* plant, botanically known as *Monarda didyma*,
typically grown as a container plant and hereinafter referred
to by the name ‘MONARD0044’.

The new *Monarda* plant is a product of a planned breed-
ing program conducted by the Inventor in Zuidwolde, The
Netherlands. The objective of the breeding program is to
create new *Monarda* plants with attractive flowers and
tolerance to Powdery Mildew.

The new *Monarda* plant originated from a cross-pollina-
tion in July, 2014 of two unnamed selections of *Monarda*
didyma, not patented. The new *Monarda* plant was discov-
ered and selected by the Inventor as a single flowering plant
from within the progeny of the stated cross-pollination
grown in a controlled environment in Zuidwolde, The Neth-
erlands in July, 2016.

Asexual reproduction of the new *Monarda* plant by veg-
etative terminal cuttings in Zuidwolde, The Netherlands,
since March, 2017 has shown that the unique features of this
new *Monarda* plant are stable and reproduced true to type in
successive generations.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Plants of the new *Monarda* have not been observed under
all possible combinations of environmental conditions and

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cultural practices. The phenotype may vary somewhat with
variations in environmental conditions such as temperature
and light intensity without, however, any variance in geno-
type.

5 The following traits have been repeatedly observed and
are determined to be the unique characteristics of
‘MONARD0044’. These characteristics in combination dis-
tinguish ‘MONARD0044’ as a new and distinct *Monarda*
plant:

- 10 1. Broadly upright plant habit.
2. Dark green-colored leaves.
3. Freely flowering habit.
4. Large inflorescences with purple violet-colored flow-
ers.
- 15 5. Long flowering period.
6. Tolerant to Powdery Mildew.

Plants of the new *Monarda* differ primarily from plants of
the parent selections in plant uniformity as plants of the new
Monarda are more uniform than plants of the parent selec-
tions.

20 Plants of the new *Monarda* can be compared to plants of
Monarda didyma ‘MONARD0039’, disclosed in U.S. Plant
Patent filed concurrently Ser. No. 15/732,923. In side-by-
side comparisons, plants of the new *Monarda* differ primar-
ily from plants of ‘MONARD0039’ in flower color as plants
25 of ‘MONARD0039’ have purple-colored flowers. In addi-
tion, plants of the new *Monarda* are more compact than
plants of ‘MONARD0039’.

Plants of the new *Monarda* can be compared to plants of
Monarda didyma ‘Purple Ann’, not patented. In side-by-side
comparisons, plants of the new *Monarda* differ primarily
30 from plants of ‘Purple Ann’ in the following characteristics:

1. Plants of the new *Monarda* are more freely flowering
than plants of ‘Purple Ann’.
2. Plants of the new *Monarda* are more tolerant to
Powdery Mildew than plants of ‘Purple Ann’.

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BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying colored photographs illustrate the
overall appearance of the new *Monarda* plant showing the

colors as true as it is reasonably possible to obtain in colored reproductions of this type. Colors in the photographs may differ slightly from the color values cited in the detailed botanical description which accurately describe the actual colors of the new *Monarda* plant.

The photograph on the first sheet is a side perspective view of a typical flowering plant of 'MONARD0044' grown in a container.

The photograph at the top of the second sheet is a close-up view of typical inflorescences of 'MONARD0044'.

The photograph at the bottom of the second sheet is a close-up view of typical leaves of 'MONARD0044'.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The aforementioned photographs and following observations, measurements and values describe plants grown during the late summer and early autumn in 19-cm containers in an outdoor nursery in Zuidwolde, The Netherlands and under cultural practices typical of commercial *Monarda* production. During the production of the plants, day temperatures ranged from 18° C. to 30° C. and night temperatures ranged from 6° C. to 18° C. Plants were one year old when the photographs and the description were taken. In the detailed description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 2015 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.

Botanical classification: *Monarda didyma* 'MONARD0044'.

Parentage:

Female, or seed, parent.—Unnamed selection of *Monarda didyma*, not patented.

Male, or pollen, parent.—Unnamed selection of *Monarda didyma*, not patented.

Propagation:

Type cutting.—By terminal vegetative cuttings.

Time to initiate roots, summer.—About 15 days at temperatures about 20° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plant, summer.—About two months at temperatures about 20° C.

Root description.—Medium in thickness, fibrous; typically creamy white in color, actual color of the roots is dependent on substrate composition, water quality, fertilizer type and formulation, substrate temperature and physiological age of roots.

Rooting habit.—Moderately freely branching; medium density.

Plant description:

Plant and growth habit.—Herbaceous perennial; broadly upright plant habit; overall plant form, obovate; moderately vigorous growth habit; moderate growth rate.

Plant height, soil level to top of foliar plane.—About 44.5 cm.

Plant height, soil level to top of floral plane.—About 48.4 cm.

Plant width.—About 52.7 cm.

Lateral branch description.—Branching habit: Freely basal branching habit with about 19 main stems. Length: About 17.7 cm. Diameter: About 4 mm. Internode length: About 5.2 cm. Strength: Strong. Aspect: About 25° to 30° from vertical. Texture and luster: Moderately pubescent; slightly glossy. Color,

developing: Close to 144B. Color, developed: Close to 143A tinged with close to 187A.

Leaf description:

Arrangement.—Opposite, simple.

Length.—About 9.8 cm.

Width.—About 5.9 cm.

Shape.—Ovate.

Apex.—Apiculate.

Base.—Truncate.

Margin.—Serrate.

Texture and luster, upper surface.—Moderately pubescent and slightly rugose; slightly glossy.

Texture and luster, lower surface.—Densely pubescent and moderately rugose; matted.

Venation pattern.—Pinnate.

Fragrance.—Moderately fragrant; pleasant, spicy.

Color.—Developing leaves, upper surface: Close to 137B. Developing leaves, lower surface: Close to 138B. Fully expanded leaves, upper surface: Slightly darker than between 147A and N189A; venation, close to N186C. Fully expanded leaves, lower surface: Close to 137B; venation, close to 146D.

Petioles.—Length: About 1.4 cm. Diameter: About 2 mm by 4 mm. Strength: Strong. Texture, upper surface: Smooth, glabrous; slightly glossy. Texture, lower surface: Densely pubescent; matte. Color, upper surface: Close to N186C. Color, lower surface: Close to 146C.

Flower description:

Flower form, arrangement and flowering habit.—Single labiate flowers arranged in large terminal globular spikes; flowers sessile; flowers face upright to outwardly; freely flowering habit with about 200 flowers developing per inflorescence and about 22,500 flowers developing per plant during the flowering season.

Natural flowering season.—Long flowering habit, plants flower from late spring into the summer in The Netherlands; plants begin flowering about two months after planting.

Postproduction longevity.—Flowers maintain good substance for about one week on the plant; flowers not persistent.

Fragrance.—None detected.

Flower buds.—Length: About 2.3 cm. Diameter: About 3.5 mm. Shape: Narrowly oblanceolate; curved. Texture and luster: Densely pubescent; matte. Color: Close to N81A; towards the apex, close to N82B; immature calyx, close to 143B to 143C.

Inflorescence height.—About 4.6 cm.

Inflorescence diameter.—About 7.7 cm.

Flower length (vertical).—About 1.6 cm.

Flower diameter (horizontal).—About 8 mm.

Flower depth (height).—About 3.6 cm.

Petals.—Arrangement: Labiate; upper lip hooded; lower lip, a single lobe; lips fused lower 66.7% of total length. Length, upper and lower lips: About 3.2 cm. Width, upper lip: About 2 mm. Width, lower lip: About 7 mm. Shape, upper lip: Lanceolate; apex, narrowly acute. Shape, lower lip: Oblanceolate; apex, emarginate. Margin, upper and lower lips: Entire; lower petal, moderately undulate. Texture and luster, upper and lower lips, upper surface: Smooth, glabrous; slightly velvety; matte. Texture and luster, upper and lower lips, lower surface:

Densely pubescent; velvety; matte. Color, upper lip: When opening and fully opened, upper surface: Close to N80B; color does not change with development. When opening and fully opened, lower surface: Close to N80A; color does not change with development. Color, lower lip: When opening and fully opened, upper surface: Close to N80B; color does not change with development. When opening and fully opened, lower surface: Close to N80C; color does not change with development.

Sepals.—Quantity and arrangement: Five in a single whorl; lower 87.5% fused into a tubular calyx. Length: About 8 mm. Width: About 1 mm. Apex: Acute. Margin: Free parts, entire. Texture and luster, upper surface: Smooth, glabrous; upper edge of tube, moderately pubescent; matte. Texture and luster, lower surface: Smooth, glabrous; upper edge of tube, moderately pubescent; slightly glossy. Color: When opening, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 143B to 143C. Fully opened, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 143C; apical margins, close to 146A.

Inflorescence bracts.—Quantity and arrangement: About nine at the base of inflorescence. Length: About 2.6 cm. Width: About 1.8 cm. Shape: Ovate. Margin: Entire. Texture, upper surface: Smooth, glabrous; slightly velvety. Texture, lower surface: Densely pubescent. Color: When opening and fully opened, upper surface: Close to between 147A and N189A. When opening and fully opened, lower surface: Close to 137B.

Reproductive organs.—Stamens: Quantity per flower: Two. Filament length: About 1.6 cm. Filament color: Close to N80C to N80D. Anther length: About 2 mm. Anther shape: Narrowly elliptic; dorsifixed. Anther color: Close to N80D. Pollen amount: Moderate. Pollen color: Close to 8C. Pistils: Quantity per flower: One. Pistil length: About 3.5 cm. Stigma diameter: About 0.5 mm. Stigma shape: Cleft, unequal. Stigma color: Close to 83B. Style length: About 3.4 cm. Style color: Close to N82A; proximally, close to NN155D. Ovary color: Close to 144B.

Seed and fruit.—Seed and fruit production have not been observed on plants of the new *Monarda* to date.

Pathogen & pest resistance: Plants of the new *Monarda* have been observed to be tolerant to Powdery Mildew (*Erysiphe cichoracearum*). Plants of the new *Monarda* have not been observed to be resistant to pests and other pathogens common to *Monarda* plants.

Garden performance: Plants of the new *Monarda* have exhibited good tolerance to rain, wind and high temperatures about 40° C. and to be suitable for USDA Hardiness Zones 5 through 10.

It is claimed:

1. A new and distinct *Monarda* plant named 'MONARD0044' as illustrated and described.

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